and ambiguities, especially the resentment between the old Chaghatai Turkmen and the newer Persian clans.

Akbar summoned Munim Khan and asked him apropos the deserting Asaf Khan, ‘Khan Baba, do you know what that Tajik* dwarf has done?’

To which Munim Khan railed, ‘How could a clerk dare do such a thing? It was you who gave him so many promotions.’

Akbar reasoned with Munim Khan saying, ‘Khan Baba, he was trained by Khwaja Jahan (a Persian). What knowledge could we have about his character?’

‘At the time he (Asaf Khan) was appointed,’ continued Munim Khan bitterly, ‘Khwaja Jahan had remarked “even a single hair of Asaf Khan is better than the whole of the Chaghatai clan”. But now the Khwaja would not tell which of the hairs of Asaf Khan is better than the Chaghatai clan.’ Saying this, Munim Khan started weeping and Akbar comforted him and said it ‘was nonsensical and mischievous’ of Khwaja Jahan to have spoken thus.

Munim Khan now tried for many months to broker peace with the rebellious Uzbeks, a peace which Todar Mal stoutly opposed, preferring confrontation, while Akbar negotiated with various parties to put pressure on Sulaiman Karrani, the Afghan, to withdraw his support of the Uzbeks. Finally, it was when the independent Raja of Orissa* ominously promised to ‘do such things to Sulaiman that he would be a warning to all strife-mongers’ that the Uzbeks were sobered somewhat in their ambitions and agreed to a meeting with Munim Khan. Ali Quli Khan and Munim Khan agreed to meet in neutral territory, in the middle of the Ganga. Near Baksar, Munim Khan embarked on a boat from one side of the river while Ali Quli got into another boat from the other side. Troops were lined up on both banks, looking at the unusual scene playing out in front of them. ‘As the two boats approached each other in the middle of the Ganga,’ remembered Bayazid, who was present at the time, ‘Ali Quli Khan rose to his feet in the boat saying, “peace be on you kaifiyat lagh”. Then he jumped into Munim Khan’s boat. ‘They embraced each other and wept bitterly to mourn… (Humayun’s) death as they had not met since then.’ A great deal had changed since these two old liegemen of Humayun’s had come to Hindustan with the previous Padshah, and the Uzbeks railed against the new order which demanded a reconfigured allegiance they deplored.